

CITY REGULATIONS

TOWN OF WILLOW CREEK



PREAMBLE

These municipal regulations for the Town of Willow Creek are established under the authority of the Willow Creek City Council and the applicable state and local laws governing municipal administration, public safety, health, sanitation, and the use of public spaces.

They define the essential rules that support community life and are intended to preserve public order, safety, quiet enjoyment, and cleanliness throughout the town.

These regulations, discussed and approved by the Willow Creek City Council during its meeting of December 15, 2024, apply to all residents, visitors, businesses, and users of public spaces in Willow Creek.

Whereas the Mayor is responsible for taking the necessary measures to preserve good order, public safety, and public health within the town;

Whereas a single reference document is useful for setting general rules applicable across the town, without prejudice to specific rules that may apply to particular activities, facilities, or public spaces;

These regulations aim to provide a harmonious living environment for all members of the community, while respecting individual and collective freedoms.

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TITLE I: GENERAL ADMINISTRATION

Article 1: City Hall and municipal services

1.1 Willow Creek City Hall is located at Grand Oak Square. It is open to the public Monday through Friday from 8:30 AM to 12:00 PM, and is closed on Saturdays and Sundays.

1.2 Municipal services include:

- Vital Records and administrative procedures
- Planning, zoning, and land use services
- Public Works and maintenance of public spaces
- Municipal public safety office
- Community social services
- Public library and media services
- Parks, recreation, and community associations
- Education and youth services
- Culture and local heritage
- Economic development and visitor services
- Communications office

1.3 Any administrative request must be submitted in writing to the Mayor or filed directly with the relevant department.

1.4 Requests for appointments with the Mayor or council members must be made in writing and must state the purpose of the request. Elected officials meet by appointment, depending on availability and assigned responsibilities.

1.5 Municipal services operate under the authority of the Town Administrator, who coordinates the town's administrative operations.

1.6 City Hall's main phone line is available during opening hours. Outside those hours, voicemail messages are recorded and processed when services reopen.

1.7 Online services are available 24/7 on the town website at willowcreek.gov.

Article 2: City Council

2.1 The City Council meets at least once each quarter in the City Council chamber. A preliminary meeting schedule is prepared twice a year and shared with residents.

2.2 City Council meetings are open to the public unless the Council votes, by the required majority of members present, to hold a closed session where permitted by law. Members of the public must remain quiet during the meeting and refrain from disruptive signs of approval or disapproval.

2.3 The meeting agenda is posted at City Hall and published on willowcreek.gov at least five days before the meeting.

2.4 Meeting minutes are available for review at City Hall after approval by the City Council and are also published on the town website.

2.5 The municipal committees meet regularly to prepare matters to be submitted to the City Council:

- Finance and general administration committee
- Planning and public works committee
- Environment and sustainability committee
- Education and youth committee
- Culture and heritage committee
- Sports and community associations committee
- Social services and community support committee
- Economic development and tourism committee

2.6 The Youth Council, made up of students from local elementary schools and the middle school, meets monthly and is consulted on projects affecting young residents.

2.7 The Senior Advisory Council, made up of volunteer retirees, serves as an advisory body on projects of general interest.

Article 3: Resident information

3.1 City Council decisions and mayoral orders are made available to the public by posting at City Hall and publishing on the town website.

3.2 A quarterly municipal bulletin, "Willow Creek News," is distributed free of charge to all households. It presents municipal updates, ongoing projects, and upcoming events.

- 3.3 The town website, willowcreek.gov, is updated regularly and provides useful information for residents.
- 3.4 Electronic notice boards located at Grand Oak Square, in front of City Hall, and in the High Banks neighborhood display urgent municipal information and event announcements.
- 3.5 The "Willow Creek Connect" mobile app allows residents to receive town notifications and report issues in public spaces.
- 3.6 Public information meetings are organized for major development projects and before the annual budget vote.
- 3.7 Elected officials hold open office hours on the first Saturday of each month from 10:00 AM to 12:00 PM at City Hall, without appointment.
- 3.8 Each January, the Mayor delivers New Year greetings to the community during an official ceremony.

Article 4: Vital records and administrative procedures

- 4.1 Birth certificates and related vital records may be requested through the Vital Records office in accordance with applicable state requirements.
- 4.2 Death certificates and related filings must be handled through the appropriate vital records process as required by state and county rules.
- 4.3 Marriage licenses and civil wedding ceremonies may be handled by City Hall by appointment, after the required application file has been completed.
- 4.4 Domestic partnership declarations or equivalent filings, where available under state or local rules, are processed by appointment after submission of the complete file.
- 4.5 Passport services may be provided by appointment where City Hall acts as an authorized passport acceptance facility. Residents must follow the documentation requirements set by the relevant federal agency.
- 4.6 Voter registration assistance is available throughout the year. To vote in a given election, residents must register by the deadline set by state law.
- 4.7 Residency letters or visitor support letters may be issued by appointment after verification of the required supporting documents.
- 4.8 Selective Service registration guidance is available for eligible residents, in accordance with federal requirements.
- 4.9 Signature notarization or certification services are provided upon presentation of a valid ID and only when permitted by applicable rules.

Article 5: Ceremonies and protocol

5.1 Official commemorative ceremonies are organized on the following civic dates:

- Martin Luther King Jr. Day: community service and remembrance
- Memorial Day: remembrance of those who died in military service
- Independence Day: civic celebration
- Labor Day: community recognition
- Veterans Day: recognition of military veterans
- Local Heritage Day: celebration of Willow Creek history

5.2 Flags on public buildings are displayed in accordance with federal, state, and local instructions.

5.3 Public facility inaugurations are announced to the entire community.

5.4 Public ceremonies are presided over by the Mayor or the Mayor's representative, in accordance with City Hall protocol.

5.5 The sister-city relationship with Weissdorf is celebrated through annual exchanges and an official ceremony every five years.

5.6 Civil wedding ceremonies are held in the City Hall ceremony room. The presiding official follows the applicable municipal protocol.

5.7 Golden anniversaries (50 years of marriage) and diamond anniversaries (60 years of marriage) may be recognized in a City Hall ceremony upon written request to the Mayor.

5.8 A welcome event for new residents is organized each September.

TITLE II: PUBLIC ORDER AND SAFETY

Article 6: Public quiet

6.1 Any unnecessary noise, or noise resulting from a lack of reasonable care, that is likely to disturb residents' peace and quiet is prohibited.

6.2 DIY and gardening work performed by private individuals with noisy tools or equipment may take place only:

- Monday through Friday from 8:30 AM to 12:00 PM and from 2:30 PM to 7:30 PM
- Saturday from 9:00 AM to 12:00 PM and from 3:00 PM to 7:00 PM
- Sunday and public holidays from 10:00 AM to 12:00 PM

6.3 Pet owners must take all appropriate measures to preserve neighborhood quiet, both day and night.

6.4 Owners and users of home or vehicle alarms must ensure that these devices do not disturb neighbors and do not trigger repeatedly without cause.

6.5 Public-facing establishments that regularly play amplified music must assess potential noise impacts and implement measures to limit disturbance.

6.6 Private festivities likely to create exceptional noise must be reported to City Hall at least 15 days before the planned date.

6.7 The use of firecrackers and other fireworks is prohibited on public roads and in public places, except with a special permit issued by the Mayor.

6.8 Sound systems installed for public events and street gatherings require prior authorization.

6.9 Drone use is subject to applicable national regulations and must respect residents' privacy and quiet enjoyment.

6.10 Noisy professional activities, including construction and deliveries, are prohibited between 8:00 PM and 7:00 AM, and on Sundays and public holidays, unless the Mayor grants an exceptional waiver.

Article 7: Traffic and parking

7.1 The speed limit is 20 mph throughout downtown and residential neighborhoods, and 30 mph on other municipal roads unless otherwise posted.

7.2 Parking is prohibited:

- on sidewalks
- across driveways or building entrances
- in spaces reserved for people with disabilities, except for vehicles displaying the appropriate permit
- in loading zones during business hours
- in spaces reserved for electric vehicles while charging
- at bus stops and school bus stops
- in areas marked by permanent or temporary no-parking signs

7.3 The downtown short-term parking zone is in effect Monday through Saturday from 9:00 AM to 7:00 PM, with a maximum parking duration of 90 minutes. Use of a valid parking disc or equivalent time indicator is required where posted.

7.4 Vehicles parked in the same location for more than seven consecutive days may be ticketed and towed.

7.5 Vehicles with a gross vehicle weight rating above 4 tons may not park in residential zones or downtown, except during delivery or moving operations.

7.6 Heavy trucks above 8 tons are prohibited in downtown, except for deliveries between 6:00 AM and 11:00 AM.

7.7 Oversized vehicle movements require prior authorization from City Hall and must follow the designated route.

7.8 Downtown pedestrian zones are closed to motor vehicles, except for emergency vehicles, law enforcement vehicles, and authorized local access.

7.9 Bike lanes are reserved for bicycles and permitted personal mobility devices, such as electric scooters, where allowed by law.

7.10 Rural and wooded paths are closed to motor vehicles, except agricultural, forestry, emergency, or duly authorized vehicles.

7.11 RV parking is allowed only in the designated area on Poplar Avenue, for a maximum duration of 72 hours.

7.12 Carpool parking areas located at the town entrances are reserved for carpool users.

Article 8: Public sanitation

- 8.1 Dumping, abandoning, throwing, or discharging waste of any kind on roads, public spaces, or private spaces within the town is prohibited and may result in a fine.
- 8.2 Household waste collection takes place on Monday and Thursday mornings. Containers must be placed outside after 7:00 PM the evening before collection and brought back in before 8:00 PM on the day following collection.
- 8.3 Recycling is mandatory. Recyclable packaging is collected on Wednesdays. Glass drop-off points are distributed throughout the town.
- 8.4 The municipal recycling center is open Tuesday through Saturday from 9:00 AM to 12:00 PM and from 2:00 PM to 6:00 PM. Access is reserved for Willow Creek residents with a badge issued by City Hall.
- 8.5 Yard waste must be taken to the recycling center or composted. Home composting is encouraged. Compost bins are available free of charge upon request at City Hall.
- 8.6 Bulky items are collected by appointment on the first Wednesday of each month, after prior registration with Public Works.
- 8.7 Property owners or tenants must keep the sidewalk and gutter in front of their property clean, including sweeping, weed removal, and snow clearing.
- 8.8 It is prohibited to let substances flow onto public roads if they could compromise sanitation, cleanliness, or public comfort.
- 8.9 Pet owners must immediately pick up animal waste on public property. Bag dispensers are available at several locations throughout town.
- 8.10 Septic tank, sump, and cesspool cleaning or pumping may be performed only by specialized and approved companies.
- 8.11 Owners or operators must maintain undeveloped lots located within residential areas or within 50 yards of homes. Brush clearing must be completed before June 30 each year.
- 8.12 Private pools must be equipped with a water-treatment system that complies with applicable regulations. Draining pools onto public roads is prohibited.

Article 9: Municipal public safety office

- 9.1 The Willow Creek municipal public safety office is composed of four officers. It is responsible for supporting enforcement of mayoral orders and recording violations of those orders.
- 9.2 Municipal public safety officers maintain a daily presence in town Monday through Saturday from 8:00 AM to 8:00 PM.
- 9.3 Outside municipal public safety service hours, the county sheriff's office, whose local station is located on School Street, provides public safety coverage for the town.
- 9.4 Video monitoring is used in certain areas of the town, in accordance with the applicable county or state authorization. Recordings are retained for 30 days and may be viewed only by authorized persons.
- 9.5 The municipal public safety office, located at Grand Oak Square, is open to the public Monday through Friday from 9:00 AM to 12:00 PM and from 2:00 PM to 5:00 PM.
- 9.6 The office may be contacted by phone at (555) 123-4567 during service hours or by email at publicsafety@willowcreek.gov.
- 9.7 Found property must be deposited at the municipal public safety office, where it is held for the legal retention period before being returned to its owner, transferred, or disposed of according to its nature.
- 9.8 The Vacation Watch program allows residents to report an absence to the municipal public safety office, which may conduct regular checks near their home.
- 9.9 Temporary encampment or long-term vehicle dwelling is prohibited within town limits outside areas specifically designated and authorized for that purpose.
- 9.10 The Mayor may, by reasoned order and where permitted by law, restrict access to certain public places for unaccompanied minors under 18 between 11:00 PM and 6:00 AM.

Article 10: Animals

10.1 Animal owners are civilly responsible for damage their animals may cause to others, even if the animals have escaped or are lost.

10.2 Dogs may not roam unattended on public roads. Dogs must be leashed in public places.

10.3 Dogs subject to special restrictions under state or local law must be registered with City Hall when required and must comply with all leash, muzzle, and handling rules that apply.

10.4 Dogs, even on leash, are prohibited in certain public parks and gardens where posted, except service animals and guide dogs.

10.5 Stray animals may be captured and taken to the intermunicipal animal shelter. Capture and boarding fees are charged to the owner.

10.6 Feeding stray or wild animals, including pigeons and feral cats, on public property is prohibited.

10.7 Keeping backyard poultry is allowed in non-urbanized areas of town, provided minimum distances from neighboring homes and sanitation conditions are respected.

10.8 Keeping non-domestic animals is subject to prior authorization and must comply with applicable regulations.

10.9 Beehives must be declared to City Hall and installed at a minimum distance of 20 yards from neighboring properties and 50 yards from public-facing establishments.

10.10 Professional kennels must be located at least 100 yards from any dwelling occupied by third parties and must be declared or authorized according to their capacity.

Article 11: Beverage service and public-facing establishments

11.1 Opening an establishment that serves alcoholic beverages is subject to prior declaration to City Hall and any applicable state licensing requirements.

11.2 Beverage-serving establishments may not be established within 100 yards of schools, sports fields, cemeteries, or places of worship where such a restriction is permitted by law.

- 11.3 The closing time for beverage-serving establishments is set at 1:00 AM. Exceptional waivers may be granted by the Mayor for specific celebrations or events.
- 11.4 Public-facing establishments must comply with safety and accessibility standards. The municipal safety committee conducts periodic inspections to verify compliance.
- 11.5 Installing outdoor seating on public property requires prior authorization from the Mayor and payment of any applicable fee. Outdoor seating must not obstruct pedestrian movement.
- 11.6 Takeout sales of alcoholic beverages are prohibited between 10:00 PM and 6:00 AM where permitted by applicable law.
- 11.7 Alcohol consumption is prohibited on public roads and in public spaces within the town, except with special authorization issued by the Mayor for events.
- 11.8 Establishments that play amplified music must comply with current acoustic standards and must not disturb neighborhood quiet.
- 11.9 Operators of public-facing establishments must ensure proper customer behavior inside and immediately around their establishments.
- 11.10 Restaurants and food sales points must comply with applicable hygiene and sanitation rules.

Article 12: Building and construction safety

- 12.1 Property owners must maintain buildings in sound condition to protect occupants and pedestrians.
- 12.2 In case of imminent danger, the Mayor may prescribe temporary measures necessary to protect safety, including evacuation of the building.
- 12.3 Construction or demolition sites must be fenced to prevent unauthorized access.
- 12.4 Scaffolding, ladders, and other suspended devices used for work must be installed in a way that presents no danger to pedestrians.
- 12.5 Lighting in common areas of multifamily buildings must be kept in good working order.
- 12.6 Chimneys, flues, and technical shafts must be cleaned at least once a year.
- 12.7 Roofs, gutters, and downspouts must be properly maintained.
- 12.8 Buildings at risk of collapse are subject to a specific procedure that may lead to an order requiring repair or demolition.
- 12.9 Balconies and terraces must not be overloaded, and guardrails must be kept in good condition.
- 12.10 Electrical, gas, and heating installations must comply with applicable standards and be inspected regularly.
- 12.11 Elevators must be covered by a maintenance contract and periodic inspections in accordance with applicable regulations.
- 12.12 Property owners or operators must clear snow and apply salt or other de-icing material to the sidewalk in front of their property when ice forms.

TITLE III: PLANNING AND ENVIRONMENT

Article 13: Planning and zoning rules

13.1 Any new construction, extension, or change to the exterior appearance of an existing building requires prior authorization, such as a building permit or prior declaration, to be filed with City Hall.

13.2 The local zoning plan defines the rules applicable within the town. It is available for review at City Hall and on the town website.

13.3 The town includes a protected historic district downtown where specific architectural requirements apply. Any facade modification in this district is subject to review by the competent heritage authority.

13.4 Planning and building applications are reviewed by the town's planning office within the legal time period applicable to the nature of the project.

13.5 Fences are subject to prior declaration throughout the town. Their height is limited to 6 feet along property lines and 5 feet along public roads.

13.6 Solar panel installation is allowed provided the integration rules defined in the zoning plan are respected. In the protected historic district, installation is subject to specific requirements.

13.7 Land divisions for construction purposes are subject to prior authorization in the zones defined by the zoning plan.

13.8 Buildings must comply with setback rules from property lines and public roads as defined in the zoning plan for each zone.

13.9 Building lot coverage may not exceed the percentages defined in the zoning plan for each zone.

13.10 Notable buildings listed in the zoning plan are subject to special protection that prohibits demolition and strictly regulates modifications.

13.11 Protected wooded areas identified in the zoning plan are subject to conservation rules. Any change of use or land occupation likely to compromise the preservation of those wooded areas is prohibited.

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